

THE BABY SHOWER CHECKLIST

Show up for her, not just the gifts.

What actually helps before, during, and after the shower — whether you're hosting, co-hosting, or just showing up. Registry-smart, budget-friendly, and focused on her, not the spotlight.

BEFORE THE SHOWER

Your job starts before the party does.

The shower itself is a few hours. The prep work is where you actually matter — the registry, the budget, the logistics that make the day easy on her instead of one more thing she's managing alone.

Registry & Planning

Build it together — don't just approve whatever she sends you.

- ☐ **Sit down and build the registry together** — not a five-minute rubber stamp on her list.
- ☐ **Include the big-ticket practical items** — car seat, stroller, crib — not just the cute small stuff.
- ☐ **Set a household budget line** for whatever the registry doesn't cover.
- ☐ **Confirm the date and venue actually work for her** — comfort near her due date beats a "perfect" venue.
- ☐ **If you're co-hosting**, split real tasks — venue, invites, food — instead of vaguely "helping."

Budget-Smart Prep

The shower rarely covers everything — plan for the gap now.

- ☐ **Track registry gaps after RSVPs come in**, not just what's left the week before.
- ☐ **Skip duplicate small stuff** — prioritize what's actually needed over what's easy to buy.
- ☐ **Check consignment or gently-used** for big-ticket items — cribs and strollers hold up fine secondhand.

During the Shower

Show up. Don't take over.

Whatever your role that day, the same rule applies: it's her day. Your job is to make it easier, not to be the center of it.

If You're Attending

- ☐ **Let her be the center of attention.** This isn't the day to compete for it, even in a small way.
- ☐ **Handle logistics quietly** — parking, gifts to the car, wrangling family — so she doesn't have to think about it.
- ☐ **Stay reachable** in case she needs an easy out, without hovering.
- ☐ **If it's a co-ed shower, actually engage** — don't disappear into a corner with the other dads all afternoon.

If You're Hosting or Co-Hosting

- ☐ **Confirm the setup and cleanup crew** ahead of time — don't leave it to be figured out that morning.
- ☐ **Handle food and dietary restrictions in advance**, not as a last-minute scramble.
- ☐ **Have a plan for gift-opening logistics** — someone tracking who-gave-what, so thank-yous aren't a guessing game later.

Ask her what she actually wants. Traditions vary by family — some showers are couples' events, some are women-only, some skip the party altogether. Follow her lead, not a template.

After the Shower

The follow-through is where most guys quietly disappear. Don't.

- ☐ **Help write and send thank-you notes** within two weeks — this is not solely her job.
- ☐ **Handle returns and exchanges** — don't let duplicate onesies pile up in a closet for months.
- ☐ **Wash and organize the new baby gear** before it's actually needed, not the week the baby's due.
- ☐ **Update your prep checklist** based on what's now covered — and what still isn't.

Your Actual Job at the Baby Shower

- ☐ **Be present, not performative.** Put the phone down and actually be part of the day.
- ☐ **Handle logistics** so she doesn't have to think about them.
- ☐ **Follow through after.** Thank-yous and returns are your job too, not just hers.
- ☐ **Show up for the day she wants** — not the version that's easiest for you.

The shower is one afternoon. Everything after it — labor, the hospital stay, the first weeks home — is what **the Dudela Prep Kit** actually walks through: six pillars, nine printable tools, real founder stories.

Real Talk from John & Mike

Neither of us knew what to do with ourselves at our own baby showers. Standing around, unsure whether to help or get out of the way, is a normal way to feel. The dads who showed up best weren't the ones who took over the party — they were the ones quietly running errands, keeping an eye on her energy, and writing thank-you notes two weeks later without being asked twice. That's the whole job. It's not complicated, it's just easy to skip.

— John & Mike, Dudela